

Lessons Learned

Closure Phase

Cloud Migration Project

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What Went Well

Area	Observation	Root Cause	Lesson	Recommendation	Future Application
Migration approach	Rehost strategy worked well for 24/32 apps	Correct initial assessment of app suitability	Thorough upfront assessment pays off	Invest in detailed discovery phase	All future migration projects
Wave sequencing	Tier 3 first approach built confidence	Lower risk first approach validated	Starting with simpler apps reduces team anxiety	Migrate simpler apps first to build capability	Future migration waves
Change control	Only 5 change requests; all managed well	Strict process from day one	Early change control prevents scope creep	Implement change control at project start	All projects
Vendor engagement	Vendor PS critical for Tier 1 migration	Vendor expertise for complex apps	Vendor partnerships matter for complex work	Engage vendor early for complex migrations	Complex technical projects
Stakeholder engagement	Regular steering committee kept sponsors engaged	Consistent communication cadence	Regular executive communication maintains support	Maintain monthly steering committee from start	All projects
Testing approach	2-week UAT windows were sufficient	Business owner input on timing	Right-sizing testing windows prevents delays	Engage business owners on testing timelines	All projects

What Did Not Go Well

Area	Observation	Root Cause	Lesson	Recommendation	Future Application
Dependency discovery	Undocumented dependencies discovered mid-migration	Insufficient initial discovery depth	Assumptions about app knowledge are dangerous	Conduct thorough dependency workshops before migration	All migration projects
Resource conflicts	UAT resource conflicts during year-end	No awareness of business calendar	Business calendar must inform project scheduling	Map business critical periods before scheduling UAT	All projects
Network design	Network design delayed 3 days, cascaded to Wave 1	Sequential approach to design and assessment	Parallel workstreams save time	Run design activities in parallel where possible	All projects
Change request CR-004	Acceleration proposal delayed due to CCB process	CCB not pre-scheduled for urgent changes	Change control must accommodate urgency	Establish emergency change process	All projects

Recommendations for Future Projects

#	Recommendation	Priority	Category
1	Conduct application dependency workshops before migration planning	High	Discovery
2	Map business critical periods (year-end, quarter-end) before scheduling	High	Planning
3	Run network design and infrastructure assessment in parallel	Medium	Planning

#	Recommendation	Priority	Category
4	Establish emergency change control process alongside standard process	Medium	Governance
5	Engage vendor professional services for Tier 1 applications from the start	Medium	Vendor
6	Invest in cloud platform training earlier in the project	Low	Training
7	Create cross-functional migration teams for better coordination	Low	Organization

AI Opportunities Identified

#	Opportunity	Description	Expected Benefit
1	AI-assisted dependency discovery	Use AI to analyze application logs and identify hidden dependencies	Reduce discovery time by 30%
2	AI-generated migration runbooks	Generate operational runbooks from cloud configuration	Reduce documentation time by 50%
3	AI-powered risk prediction	Analyze historical data to predict migration risks	Improve risk identification by 25%
4	AI-assisted UAT test generation	Generate UAT test cases from application requirements	Reduce UAT preparation by 40%
5	AI-driven cost optimization	Continuous analysis of cloud costs for optimization	Reduce cloud costs by 10-15%

Key Metrics

Metric	Value
Total project duration	10.5 months (vs. 18-month plan)
Budget variance	+\$55K (+1.7%)
Schedule variance	+3 days (0.5%)
Scope completion	94% (30/32 apps)
Change requests	5 (all managed)
Lessons captured	10
Recommendations	7
AI opportunities	5

Traceability: This document is derived from the Closure Readiness Checklist (CMP-CLOS-01), Deliverable Acceptance (CMP-CLOS-02), and all execution/monitoring data. It feeds into the Final Project Report (CMP-CLOS-10).